

Mike Lyons

Founding Engineer · Startup CTO

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AI × firmware × software. I build products people love, and I'm looking to push what hardware can do.

EXPERIENCE

hi finance
CTO / Co-Founder
Canada | May 2025 - Present

- Lead engineering as co-founder of a Canadian fintech. Built a custom **agent harness and software factory** that writes and ships its own code, so 1 engineer and 2 operations staff run three mobile apps, a web app, and an in-house CRM.
- Shipped an AI grant application system that lets any university student claim student aid from their phone, without ever opening the original application site. Over **3,000 students** have used it to claim more than **$4M in funding**.

Stealth AI Startup
CTO / Co-Founder
San Francisco | Mar 2024 - May 2025

- Co-founded a pre-seed startup and raised **$2.5M** to put LLMs to work in sectors that had barely been touched by them: commercial HVAC, fast-casual restaurants, and dental insurance. Led the technical work and ran customer discovery in each.

Verkada
Head of Software, Intercom
San Francisco Bay Area | 2021 - Dec 2023

- Built and launched Verkada's Intercom product line, its most successful launch ever at **$14M in year one**, hiring and leading the **8 engineers** who shipped it on a tight deadline.

Dor Technologies
Head of AI
Cofounder
San Francisco | 2015 - 2021

- Shipped a battery-powered, neural-net-driven IoT device deployed across thousands of retail sites as a **founding engineer**, later leading the AI team as it grew to **10**.
- Built the data pipeline and fullstack analytics platform that processed millions of events from thousands of edge ML devices.

Mark One / MyVessyl
Software Engineer
San Francisco | 2014 – 2015

- Designed and built the backend infrastructure behind an AI-driven consumer hardware device.

Apple
Software Engineering Co-op
Cupertino | 2013 - 2014

- Built a fullstack JS application that turns hundreds of thousands of tickets into usable reports, and improved the scalability of the MDM product line.

Earlier

- Technical Cofounder at CareerLabs (2015 – 2016). Software engineering intern at InstallNet & Aertight Systems, Annapolis MD (2011 – 2012).

OPEN SOURCE

Ness
Creator & Primary Author
Open Source | 2026 - Present

- An open-source IDE for coding with agents: parallel agent sessions across git worktrees, each with its own terminal, shell, and a browser the agent drives directly.